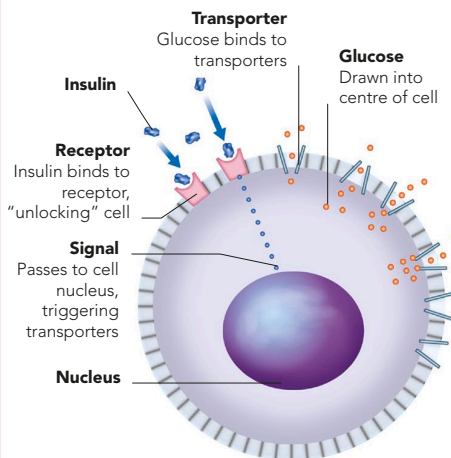
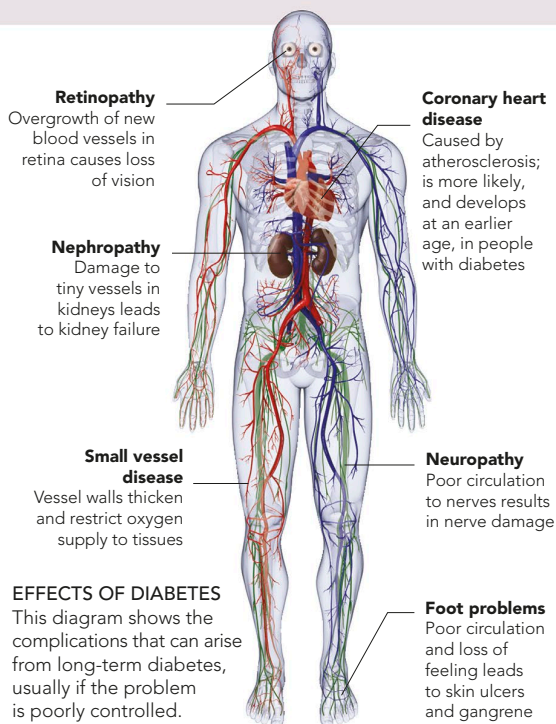


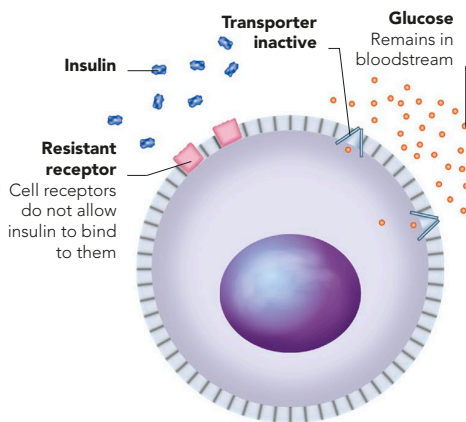
## TYPE 2 DIABETES

In type 2 diabetes, the pancreas secretes insulin, but the body cells are unable to respond to it. The causes are complex, including genetic predisposition and lifestyle factors. This form of diabetes is often associated with obesity and is a growing problem in affluent societies. The disorder develops slowly. There may be initial symptoms such as thirst, fatigue, and frequent urination, but in some cases the diabetes goes unnoticed for several years. As a result, complications may arise. Persistent high glucose levels can cause damage to small blood vessels around the body. People with type 2 diabetes are also more prone to high cholesterol levels, atherosclerosis (see p.157), and high blood pressure. The condition can be controlled with a healthy diet, regular exercise, and daily monitoring of blood glucose. However, in some cases, drugs are needed to boost insulin production or help the cells to absorb glucose.



### NORMAL RECEPTORS

Insulin binds with receptors on a cell to allow glucose to enter the cell. This, in turn, triggers transporters in the cell to draw glucose inside.



### MALFUNCTIONING RECEPTORS

People with type 2 diabetes produce enough insulin, but the receptors are resistant to it and glucose cannot be taken into cells.